

Choose FI is that they can't develop a high savings rate because they are hampered by student loan debt.

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When I am asked about my biggest financial mistake, the answer is obvious: Going to pharmacy school. It took 12 years of my life and left me with \$168,000 of student loan debt. I got back to broke at the age of thirty-two. This was only possible, however, because I focused my energy on paying off my debt with extreme intensity, at the expense of other goals.

Going to pharmacy school was a financial mistake, but it wasn't a life mistake. It's become part of my story and motivation to help people who are on a similar path. Your past doesn't define you. Many people find the concept of FI after having made significant financial mistakes. It's important to recognize past mistakes and address them. As the Chinese proverb says, "The best time to plant a tree was twenty years ago. The second-best time is right now."

If you're in that situation, it's important to determine the optimal strategy to pay the least amount of money to satisfy your financial obligations. That's not easy. There are multiple loan forgiveness